

Roasted Cauliflower Steaks with Romesco (Variation 5)

Tags: vegetarian, vegan, gluten-free, dinner, spanish | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 35 min | Serves: 3

Ingredients

- 1.5 large heads cauliflower
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 0.8 tsp smoked paprika
- 0.8 tsp garlic powder
- Salt and black pepper
- Romesco: 1.5 roasted red peppers (jarred), 60 g blanched almonds toasted, 2 garlic cloves, 2 tbsp red wine vinegar, 1 tbsp smoked paprika, 4 tbsp olive oil, pinch of cayenne, salt
- toasted flaked almonds and fresh cilantro to serve

Method

1. Preheat oven to 220 °C. Line two large baking trays.
2. Remove outer leaves from cauliflower. Slice each head into 2–3 thick steaks from the centre, reserving florets.
3. Mix olive oil, paprika, garlic powder, salt, and pepper. Brush over both sides of each steak and toss florets in remaining oil.
4. Arrange on baking trays in a single layer. Roast for 30–35 minutes, flipping once, until deeply caramelised.
5. For romesco: blend all ingredients to a slightly chunky sauce. Taste and adjust acidity and seasoning.
6. Spread romesco generously on serving plates. Place cauliflower steaks on top.
7. Scatter with toasted almonds and fresh parsley.

Chef Tips

- A very hot oven and proper spacing are key to caramelisation rather than steaming.
- Romesco can be made 5 days ahead and refrigerated — the flavour improves.
- The outer florets that don't hold together as steaks are just as delicious and can be served alongside.